

IG REELS SCRIPT: The Art Market Just Woke Up

Total runtime: ~55 seconds | Visual: fast cuts, auction footage, paddle raises, price tickers | Structure: MrBeast retention model

[0:00 – 0:03] HOOK

MrBeast Rule #1: Promise the payoff instantly.

VOICEOVER (urgent, hushed): “In ten minutes, five billionaires fought over a single painting — and the art market just flipped a switch.”

ON SCREEN: “Someone just paid \$181 MILLION for paint splatter.”

VISUAL: Pollock *Number 1A, 1948* zoom-in → gavel slam → price ticker spinning up.

[0:03 – 0:12] RESTATE THE STAKES

Hook the skeptic with the receipts.

VOICEOVER: “Last night at Christie’s, a Jackson Pollock drip painting sold for **\$181.2 million**. Sixty bids. A ten-minute war. New world record.”

VOICEOVER: “Then a Brancusi bronze the size of a melon went for **\$107 million**. Also a record.”

ON SCREEN: “\$181,200,000” stamps in. “RECORD” flashing.

VISUAL: Cut between Pollock canvas and the Brancusi bronze head rotating on a pedestal.

[0:12 – 0:25] ESCALATION

MrBeast Rule: bigger number every beat.

VOICEOVER: “Both came from one collection — S.I. Newhouse. Sixteen lots. **\$630 million** in a single night.”

VOICEOVER: “But here’s why it actually matters...”

ON SCREEN: Stack-of-bills graphic counting up to \$630M.

VISUAL: Smash cut to black after the line. One beat of silence.

[0:25 – 0:42] THE BIGGER STORY

Pay off the hook with the macro thesis.

VOICEOVER: “U.S. auction sales just jumped **23%** — the first growth year since 2022. Christie’s is targeting one-and-a-half billion this May alone. Sotheby’s set their estimate **70% higher** than last year.”

VOICEOVER: “Since 1995, contemporary art has returned **11.4% a year** — that’s 43% more than the S&P 500.”

ON SCREEN: Bar chart climbing. Headlines: “Market Rebounds.” “First Growth Since 2022.”

VISUAL: Split-screen art index vs. S&P line chart.

[0:42 – 0:52] THE THESIS

Why the viewer should care.

VOICEOVER (slower, serious): “Wealth managers are calling it the next trillion-dollar asset class. Younger collectors are putting up to **30%** of their portfolios into art. And the smart money? It’s not waiting anymore.”

ON SCREEN: “\$2.86 TRILLION by 2026” — Pollock painting fades in behind.

VISUAL: Slow push-in on the Pollock. Music swells.

[0:52 – 0:55] CLOSE

Loop / CTA. Never let energy drop.

VOICEOVER: “The art market didn’t crash. It was just loading. Follow for what they’re buying next.”

ON SCREEN: “FOLLOW →” pulse.

VISUAL: Cut to gavel slam from the opening. Loop-ready ending.

Production Notes

- **Hook A/B variant:** “A painting that looks like spilled coffee just sold for \$181 million.”
- **Caption:** “The art market just had its loudest night since 2022. Pollock \$181M. Brancusi \$107M. One night. \$630M. The shift is on.”
- First 3 frames MUST contain price + artwork. IG retention dies after second 2.
- **Audio:** Tense cinematic build (Zimmer-lite). Drop music entirely on “but here’s why it matters” for contrast.
- **Aspect:** 9:16, 1080×1920. Caption-burn all VO for sound-off viewing.

Sources

Pollock and Brancusi Join the \$100M Club

dnyuz.com — May 18, 2026

\$181.2M Pollock, \$107.6M Brancusi Sell at Christie’s

Artnet News

Christie’s S.I. Newhouse Sale Totals \$630.8M

ARTnews

U.S. Art Market Rebounds, +23% in Auction Sales

Bank of America — March 2026

NY Auctions Test Recovery with \$2.6B on Offer

Prism News

Art as the Next Trillion-Dollar Frontier

Maddox Gallery

Christie’s, Sotheby’s Report Annual Sales Increases

Artnet News